The "Manasollasa" of Sureshvaracharya — A Commentary on the "Dakshinamurti-stotra"

A complete reference: what this text is, when it was written, what it contains, which manuscripts and editions exist, and what exactly it says about asanas

Compiled 31 October 2026.

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0. How to Read This Reference

This reference is written so that it can be read without specialist knowledge: every term is explained either along the way or in the glossary (§9), and every person mentioned is listed in §1.6.

Conventions that apply throughout the text:

- **All Sanskrit quotations have been checked against photographs of the printed pages** at original resolution (JPEG 2000 image files from the Internet Archive). The passage on asanas is given according to the 2008 edition and collated with the 1895 edition; for verses 24–26 the two editions **agree word for word**.
- In the 2008 edition (p. 119) verse 24 is set as ...ब्राह्ममासनम्॥२४॥ — the number follows the word immediately. Some settings of the same text show the separate form with two dandas (...ब्राह्ममासनम् ॥२४॥). This is a typographical detail; it does not affect the reading.
- Why quotations must not be taken from the text files supplied with the scans: optical recognition of Devanagari regularly confuses similar letters and loses diacritics. This has been verified on fresh downloads: in the text files of the 1895 edition one indeed finds खरस्तिकं for स्वस्तिकं, पश्यं for पद्मं, धारं for वीरं, and नृपिहादि for नृसिंहादि — although the book itself prints the correct reading on p. 156.
- Crops of every quoted page are kept in the folder `sources/scans/mss/`, so that each quotation can be checked by eye.
- Page references are given **by the printed page numbers** (the ones in the running head), not by the leaf number of the scan. Where a leaf number is used, this is stated explicitly.
- Translations from Sanskrit are my own; where a passage is disputed, the English translation of A. Mahadeva Sastri (editions of 1899/1978) is placed alongside for comparison.
- **Sanskrit is given in Latin transliteration** in the simplified form conventional in English: Shankara, Sureshvara, Mandana Mishra, Manasollasa, Dakshinamurti-stotra. Diacritics are used only where a quotation reproduces the original spelling, and in the bibliographic section (§10), where titles must match catalogue records exactly. Devanagari quotations are left in the original script.
- **Names of deities and words long naturalised in English** — Brahma, Vishnu, Rudra, Shiva, Shakti, Brahman, yoga, Sanskrit — are written without diacritics, because they are English words, not transliterations.
- **Sources written in English are quoted in the original**, since in this edition the original is English. Sources in Sanskrit and in Russian are quoted in English translation; where the wording matters, the original is given in a footnote.

- Everything marked **"not established"** could not be determined from the available sources. Such places are never filled in with guesses.
- Where a quotation is given from another author's paraphrase rather than from the work itself, this is stated.

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1. What This Text Is

1.1. Varttika — What the Word Means

The "Manasollasa" is not an independent treatise but a **varttika**. The definition is given by the editor of 1895:

> "'Varttika' is defined thus: Uktanukta-duruktartha-vyaktikari tu varttikam. A varttika is that which clearly explains what has been said, what has not been said, and what has been badly said."
>
> — A. Mahadeva Sastri, preface to the first edition, 24 May 1899 (quoted from the 3rd edition, p. 5 of the preface; full description in §10)

A varttika, then, is a genre of commentary that does not merely interpret another text but supplements and corrects it. The "Manasollasa" interprets a hymn of ten stanzas attributed to Shankara.

The title मानसोल्लास literally means "the play of the mind" or "the rejoicing of the mind". The English translator renders it as "the brilliant play of thought" (ibid.).

1.2. What the "Dakshinamurti-stotra" Is

The hymn is known as the "Dakshinamurti-stotra", after the name that stands at the end of every stanza. But the title is misleading, and the editor expressly says so:

> "The hymn is termed Dakshinámúrti-Stotra merely because the name Dakshinámúrti occurs in the last line of each verse as the burthen of the hymn. **It is not dedicated to the worship of any form of Śiva as the title may at first sight imply.** The chief object of the hymn is, as stated in the Vārtika, to expound briefly the nature of the Ātman — the highest self of man as of all other beings, its relation to the Universe, the means by which it may be realised, and the final bliss resulting from this realisation."
>
> — Preface to the 1895 edition, p. 4 (text keyed by volunteers of the Ambuda portal)

He then explains how such a text is to be read:

> "In meditating upon the truths embodied in this short hymn with a view to their complete realisation, the devotee has to bear in mind the fact that the Ātman is Parameśvara, the Supreme Lord Himself, and to look upon his Guru, the spiritual teacher, as the embodiment of the Supreme Lord. The problems to which the hymn is intended to offer solutions are stated in the initial verses of the Vārtika and at the commencement of the several sections thereof. They comprise the main heads of the subject-matter of the Brahma-sūtras and are arranged in a similar order."
>
> — ibid.

And one further observation, directly relevant to our subject (asanas):

> "Though the hymn discovers no mark of preference on the part of its author for the Śaiva religion in general or any particular form of it, **the author of the Vārtika cannot be said to have been completely free from the influence of the Śaiva cult. He invokes Śaivic gods and goddesses at the commencement of his work and draws [on] Śaiva-Āgamas, or similar works dedicated to the Śaiva cult, for the classification and nomenclature of the principles constituting human nature and the cosmos.** The details connected with the mystic practices recommended in the work may also for the most part be traced to the same source."
>
> — ibid., pp. 4–5

This is the key to the section on asanas: the classification of asanas by deity (brahma, vaishnava, raudra, shakta, shaiva) is part of that same Shaiva scheme of which the editor speaks.

The content of the hymn itself, as it reads in the text, is a contemplation of the Atman through the image of Dakshinamurti. The ninth stanza of the hymn (in the printed edition it carries the number 19) enumerates eight principles:

चन्द्रार्कौ कालनेतारौ प्राणापानौ शरीरिणाम् ।
साक्षी पुरुष इत्येवं मृत्योष्टकमिदं वपुः ॥१९॥

(1895 edition, p. 154)

"The moon and the sun, the movers of time, are the prana and the apana of embodied beings; the witness is Purusha. Thus [is contemplated] this body as eightfold, [and thus is] death [overcome]."

The commentary on the next stanza explains the sense:

एवमष्टमूर्तिस्वरूपं देहं एव सम्पाद्य ध्यायतः फलमाह — समनस्कमिति ॥

(1895 edition, p. 154)

"Such is the fruit for one who, having made the body itself, in the form of eight forms, [the object of contemplation], meditates…"

1.3. The Place of the "Manasollasa" among the Works of Sureshvara

> "There is a Vārtika or commentary by Sureśvarāchārya on this hymn, named Mānasollāsa. **It is one of the five Vārtikas attributed to Sureśvarāchārya.**"
>
> — Preface to the 1895 edition, p. 3

> "Five works of the kind are attributed to Suresvaracharya, all of them having been recently published in India: (1) Manasollasa (Mysore). (2) Pranava-vartika (''). … (4) An exposition of Sankaracharya's commentary on the Taittiriya-Upanishad (Poona, Ānandasrama Series). (5) An exposition of Sankaracharya's commentary on the Brihadaranyaka-Upanishad (Poona, Ānandasrama Series)."
>
> — Preface to the first edition, 1899 (1978 edition, pp. 6–7 of the preface)

From the same series: the "Manasollasa" and the "Pranava-vartika" were published in Mysore, and the "Naishkarmya-siddhi" in the "Bombay Sanskrit Series" (footnote ibid.).

1.4. The Structure of the Text and Its Numbering (Important for References)

The text is divided into **ullasas** (उल्लास, "wave") — one for each of the ten stanzas of the

hymn. Within each ullasa the verses are counted separately.

It is easy to go wrong here, so let me take an example. In the printed edition the stanzas of the hymn itself do not carry separate numbers 1–10: they are included in the continuous numbering of the ullasa's verses. Hence the ninth stanza of the hymn (the one the ninth ullasa interprets) appears as **verse 19**, and the verses of the varttika that follow it are 20, 21, 22, 23 and so on. The section on asanas is **verses 24–26**.

Hence the rule for references: `9.24` is read as "ullasa nine, verse twenty-four", not as "verse 24 of the hymn".

The numbering in the different editions almost coincides, but not entirely. In the "Madhuri" edition (1987) the stanza boundaries are shifted by half a verse: the half-verse which in the 1895 edition belongs to verse 23 is marked there as ॥२४ क॥ ("24a"). In the English translation (1899/1978) the section on asanas appears as "24-26", while the closing verse निरालम्बतया ध्यानं is already assigned to number 27. A reference must therefore always state the edition.

Length. According to Swami Harshananda the text contains 367 shlokas:

> "an exhaustive gloss (vārttika) by Sureśvara (A. D. 800) on the famous hymn … of Śaṅkara (A. D. 788-820)"
>
> — Hindupedia, article "Mānasollāsa": the same source states that the text contains 367 shlokas and that Ramatirtha's commentary is dated to the 17th century.

This is a figure taken from a reference work, not a fact verified against the editions: the available editions contain no continuous count of shlokas.

1.5. Different Texts Bearing the Same Title

Several different works bear the word "Manasollasa", and catalogues confuse them. They are listed here so that the reader does not mix them up:

1. **Our text** — Sureshvara's varttika on the "Dakshinamurti-stotra".
2. **"Manasollasa-vardhini"** (मानसोल्लासवर्धिनी) — the commentary of Anantakrishna Shastri (20th c.), published in 2008.
3. **"Madhuri"** (माधुरी) — the commentary of Swami Maheshananda Giri (ed. 1987).
4. **The "Manasollasa" of Someshvara 3** — an encyclopaedia of the Western Chalukya court, 1131. A completely different work.
5. **The "Manasollasa" of Appayya Dikshita** — 17 verses.
6. **The "Manasollasa" of Krishnananda** and **the "Manasollasa" of Govinda** — other texts.
7. **"Jayamadhava-manasollasa"** — a work on architecture.

In Aufrecht's "Catalogus Catalogorum" our text appears not under its own title but under the heading "Dakshinamurti-stotra": "Manasollasa … — by Sureshvara. See Dakshinamurti-stotra" (quoted from wisdomlib, article "Manasollasa"). This explains why a search for the word "Manasollasa" in manuscript catalogues turns up mainly the encyclopaedia of Someshvara.

1.6. Dramatis Personae

Without this table the reader would have to guess who all the persons mentioned are.

Who	What is known about them from verified sources
Shankara (Shankaracharya, Adi Shankara)	Founder of Advaita Vedanta; according to the editor of 1895 the commentaries on the Upanishads, the "Bhagavadgita" and the "Brahma-sutras" are his. The hymn is attributed to him
Sureshvaracharya	"his immediate disciple and co-worker in literary labour" (preface to the 1899 edition); known as the **varttikakara** — the author of varttikas; five varttikas are attributed to him, including the "Manasollasa"
Mandana Mishra	Author of the "Brahmasiddhi"; in tradition, a Mimamsaka converted by Shankara. 1899 edition: "the chief object of Sankaracharya's missionary wanderings was to secure the conversion of the distinguished Mimāmsaka to his own system of Vedanta"
Vachaspati Mishra	Author of the "Nyaya-suchi-nibandha", dated by Dasgupta to 842; he wrote a commentary on Mandana's "Brahmasiddhi" (Dasgupta, vol. 2)
Sarvajnatman Muni	Author of the "Samkshepa-shariraka"; a pupil of Sureshvara (Dasgupta, vol. 2)
Svayamprakasha Yati	Author of the "Tattvasudha", a commentary on the hymn itself; printed together with the "Manasollasa"
Ramatirtha	Author of a commentary on the varttika; 17th c., according to Harshananda
A. Mahadeva Sastri	Editor of the Sanskrit text of 1895 and of the English translation of 1899
Anantakrishna Shastri	Author of the "Manasollasa-vardhini", d. 15 November 1964; according to the English preface of 2008: "he wrote the 'Nyaya-chandrika' and the 'Madhva-chandrika' in order to refute respectively the positions of Nyaya and of Madhva"
Swami Maheshananda Giri	Mahamandaleshvara; commissioned the "Vardhini", author of the preface to the 2008 edition and of the commentary "Madhuri" (1987)
Dr Sachchidananda Mishra	Editor of the 2008 edition (Kashi Hindu University)
D. S. Subbaramaiya	Author of a two-volume study based on the "Manasollasa" and the "Tattvasudha" (Sringeri, 1988/1990)
Swami Harshananda	Translator of the text into English (Ramakrishna Math)

2. Dating

2.1. The Starting Point: the Text Is Not Dated by Itself

No separate study of the dating of the "Manasollasa" exists. All existing datings are derivative: first the author, Sureshvaracharya, is dated, and then the date is transferred to the text. And the dating of Sureshvara depends on two things: which date for Shankara is accepted, and whether the identity of Sureshvara with Mandana Mishra is admitted.

This situation was recorded not in the scholarly literature but by the editor of the 19th century himself:

> "Notwithstanding the attempts of several oriental scholars to fix the date of Śaṅkarāchārya, there has been a certain amount of uncertainty regarding it, the date assigned to him varying from the sixth century before Christ to the eighth century A. D. The date of Sureśvarāchārya,

closely connected as it is with that of his reputed teacher, has not been more satisfactorily settled."

— Preface to the 1895 edition, p. 3 (keyed by the Ambuda portal)

And on the attribution as such — note this, it is a key fact:

"**Nowhere in the hymn or the commentary is the author of either mentioned by name.** The commentator refers in his Vārtika to the author of the hymn by mere general terms such as Kavi (author) and Guru (teacher). The style and the subject-matter, however, of the two works incline us to believe in their genuineness."

— ibid.

That is: the author's name is never once stated in the text, and the attribution rests on style and subject-matter alone. This must be borne in mind when reading any dating.

2.2. Traditional (Hagiographic) Dates

These are dates from monastic lists of successors, not scholarly datings.

Date	Source	Argument
Shankara born **509 BCE**	Guru-paramparas of the Kalika Matha (Dvaraka) and the Sharada Matha (Kanchi)	"The list of the Kalika Matha in the West gives 2631 of the Yudhishthira era for the birth of Shankara, which corresponds to 509 BCE"; the Kanchi list gives 2593 of the Kali yuga, that is, the same 509 BCE
Shankara born **44 BCE**	The list of the Shringeri Matha	3058 of the Kali yuga; the source itself admits that the list is defective: "counting only 35 successors, it gives an implausible reign of 785 years for the second successor"
Shankara **788–820 CE**	The "traditional" date of the school; going back to the chronogram of K. B. Pathak, 1882	"K. B. Pathak published in 1882 a chronogram from a little-known manuscript, giving dates corresponding to 788 CE for Shankara's birth and 820 for his death"

All three quotations are from The Original Śaṅkarācārya (easterntradition.org), where the guru-parampara data are collected.

2.3. The Camp of "Shankara 788–820 ⇒ Sureshvara c. 800"

S. N. Dasgupta, A History of Indian Philosophy, vol. 2 (1932), the chapter on the Shankara school. Dates: Sureshvara — 800 CE, Sarvajnatman — 900 CE. Arguments:

"Hence there seems to be no reason why the traditionally accepted view that Śaṅkara was born in Samvat 844, or A.D. 788, or Kali age 3889, should be given up."

"Taking the approximate date of Śaṅkara's death to be about A.D. 820 and taking into consideration that Sureśvara, the teacher of Sarvajñātman, occupied his high pontifical position for a long time, the supposition that Sarvajñātman lived in A.D. 900 may not be very far wrong."

"…Vācaspati, who probably wrote his earlier work the Nyāya-sūcī-nibandha in A.D. 842, also

wrote his commentary on Maṇḍana's Brahma-siddhi when Sureśvara was occupying the pontifical position."

And his own caveat:

"The exact date of neither Sureśvara nor Sarvajñātma can be definitely determined."

(All four from Dasgupta, A History of Indian Philosophy, vol. 2; from the text at wisdomlib, "A History of Indian Philosophy", vol. 2.)

The same date is repeated by:

- **Swami Harshananda** — "Sureshvara (A. D. 800)" (Hindupedia, article "Mānasollāsa");
- **Hindu Blog**, article "Manasollasa of Sureshvara" (2024) — "written by Sureshvara around 800 CE";
- **P. S. Roodurmum**, Bhāmatī and Vivaraṇa Schools of Advaita Vedānta (2002), pp. 29–30 — "flourished c. 800–900 CE" (as reported in Wikipedia, article "Sureśvara").

2.4. The Camp of "Shankara c. 700 ⇒ Sureshvara early 8th Century"

Author	Date	Work in which it is stated
Paul Hacker	Shankara "c. 700 CE" — the first to say so	"Zur Geschichte und Beurteilung des Hinduismus", OLZ 59 (1964), col. 231
Allen W. Thrasher	Mandana and Shankara c. 700	"The Dates of Maṇḍana Miśra and Śaṅkara", WZKS 23 (1979), pp. 117–139
Karl H. Potter	Mandana "660–720 CE"; Shankara — "late 7th to early 8th century"	Encyclopedia of Indian Philosophies: Advaita Vedānta (1981), pp. 346 and 116
Carmen Dragonetti and Fernando Tola	Mandana and Shankara 660–790	"On the Date of Maṇḍana Miśra and Śaṅkara and their Doctrinal Relation", ABORI (1989)
Hajime Nakamura	Shankara 700–750	A History of Early Vedānta Philosophy, Part I (1983/1990), pp. 48–88; a special section "On the relation of the dates of Sureśvara and Śaṅkara", p. 72

Quotations:

"Maṇḍana Miśra must have lived around A.D. 660-720" (p. 346); Shankara — "late seventh and early eighth centuries" (p. 116).

— Potter, Encyclopedia of Indian Philosophies, vol. 3, as reported by Dragonetti and Tola

"Both Maṇḍana Miśra and Śaṅkara likely lived between 660-790 A.D."; "Maṇḍana Miśra critiques Śaṅkara's ideas in his works, indicating contemporaneity"; the authors also note "the limitations of asserting one philosopher influenced the other".

— Dragonetti and Tola, ABORI, 1989, abstract

"Hacker 1964 (OLZ 59, col. 231) was the first to give the date about 700 A.D.; Thrasher 1979 defends the same thesis with a large exposition of arguments."

— ibid.

"Early scholars placed him from 788–820 CE. Nakamura (1983: 48–88) argues for an earlier date of 700–750 CE… Potter (1981: 14–15, 116–119) places him from the late seventh to early

> eighth centuries CE."
>
> — Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy, article "Śaṅkara", section 1

Caveat: the text of the works of Thrasher and Nakamura is not available in the public domain (neither open access nor Google Books search). Their arguments are given here in the form in which Dragonetti and Tola and the Stanford Encyclopedia report them — that is a paraphrase, not a quotation from the original.

2.5. The Dispute on Which Everything Depends: Sureshvara = Mandana?

If they are one person, the text falls in the early 8th century. If they are different, it falls in the 8th–9th centuries.

Against the identification:

- **M. Hiriyanna**, "Sureśvara and Maṇḍana-Miśra", JRAS 55/2 (April 1923), pp. 259–263; continuation ibid., 56/1 (1924), pp. 96–97. Arguments: doctrinal divergences, and the Shringeri tradition, in which Mandana and Sureshvara are different persons.
- **S. Kuppuswami Sastri** — introduction to the critical edition of the "Brahmasiddhi" (1937; reprinted 1984).
- **S. N. Dasgupta** — A History of Indian Philosophy, vol. 2 (1932).
- **S. S. Sharma**, Advaita Tradition in Indian Philosophy (1997), pp. 290–291 — sets out the arguments of Hiriyanna and Kuppuswami Sastri.

For the identification:

- **R. Balasubramanian**: "there is no convincing evidence to prove that Maṇḍana … are different persons" (as reported in Wikipedia, article "Sureśvara").
- **The Shringeri Matha** — officially, in the documents of the matha and in hagiographies.

What the divergences consist in (after Sharma and Wikipedia):

- **where avidya** (ignorance) is located: in Mandana it is in the jiva (the individual being), in Sureshvara in Brahman. This reflects the two sub-schools of Advaita — Bhamati and Vivarana;
- **the role of meditation**: for Mandana, knowledge from the mahavakya ("great sayings" of the Upanishads) alone is not enough, meditation is required; for Sureshvara knowledge liberates directly, and meditation is an aid;
- **the attitude to sphota** (the doctrine that the meaning of a word manifests in the sound as such): Mandana accepts shabdadvaita, Sureshvara ignores it.

2.6. What the Text Itself Says

In the ninth ullasa, in the commentary on verse 23½, the author refers to **his own** commentary on Mandana's "Brahmasiddhi". Reading from the scan of the 2008 edition, p. 119 (`sources/scans/mss/2008-str119-celekom.png`):

इति मण्डनसिद्धान्त एव सुरेश्वरस्यापि सम्मतः।
तदनुषङ्गतः शाब्दापरोक्षवादोऽपि।
विशदं चैतत् ब्रह्मसिद्धौ, तद्भूमिकायाञ्चास्मदीयायाम्॥२३१/२॥

"Thus, **the doctrine of Maṇḍana is accepted by Sureshvara too**; and, following from it, the doctrine of shabda-aparoksha (immediate knowledge arising from the word). This is set

out in detail in the 'Brahmasiddhi' and **in our own bhumika** to it."

Two circumstances must be kept in mind:

1. The word अस्मदीया ("our") is the author's direct reference to his own commentary on the "Brahmasiddhi". This is internal evidence in favour of the identification, and it is usually quoted precisely in this dispute.
2. It **does not settle** the question: the commentary on the "Brahmasiddhi" could also have been written by a pupil.

2.7. The Position of the Editors of 2008

The Hindi preface to the 2008 edition is a rare case of an editor setting out both the argument and the counter-argument.

> «कुछ आधुनिकों ने इस स्तोत्र को अभिनवगुप्त के प्रत्यभिज्ञादर्शन का ग्रन्थ माना है।»
>
> — "Some modern [scholars] have regarded this stotra as a text of Abhinavagupta's Pratyabhijna-darshana" (p. i). It was precisely to answer this that the commentary "Manasollasa-vardhini" was commissioned.

> «एतिहासिक दृष्टि से मण्डन आचार्य के पूर्ववर्ती थे।»
>
> — "From the historical point of view Mandana was a predecessor of the Acharya [Shankara]" (p. ii).

The counter-argument against the identification, given in the same place: in the "Brihadaranyaka-varttika" Mandana is spoken of in the third person with the pejorative पण्डितम्मन्य ("one who fancies himself learned"), which no one writes of himself.

2.8. The Result on Dating

A formulation that can be defended:

> The "Manasollasa" is dated by its author, Sureshvaracharya, and not by internal data of the text. Depending on the date of Shankara accepted (788–820 or c. 700) and on the outcome of the dispute over the identification of Sureshvara with Mandana Mishra, the text is assigned either to the **early 8th century (c. 700–730)** or to the **8th–9th centuries**. There is no independent dating of the text on internal grounds in the literature.

A supporting boundary that does not depend on the dispute: **Vachaspati Mishra**, writing according to Dasgupta in 842, quotes Sureshvara — which gives an upper bound ("terminus ante quem") in the 9th century.

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3. What the Treatise Describes

3.1. The Design: Yoga Here Is a Means, Not an End

The "Manasollasa" is a philosophical commentary. Yogic material occupies a subordinate place in it, and the text says so itself:

बिना केवलात्मोपासनमविद्यानिवर्तकमात्मानं लभते।
अतो योगाभ्यासाङ्गम्, तदुपायो वाऽनेन प्रतिपाद्यते।

(2008 edition, p. 119)

"Without [the practice of] the worship of the Atman alone, one does not attain the Atman who removes ignorance. Therefore [yoga] is set out here as a limb of yogic practice, or as its means."

3.2. The Ninth Ullasa: Verse by Verse

Below is the composition of the ninth ullasa according to the printed edition of 1895. Verse numbers and pages are those of this edition; all quotations are taken from the scans.

Verses 17–18, pp. 153–154 — the five breaths and space. The five vayus are enumerated:

नागो हिक्काकरः कूर्मो निमेषोन्मेषकारकः ।
क्षुतं करोति कृकरो देवदत्तो विजृम्भणम् ॥१७॥

"Naga causes hiccups, Kurma the closing and opening of the eyes, Krikara sneezing, Devadatta yawning." Verse 18 concerns akasha: आकाशो बहिरप्यन्तरवकाशं प्रयच्छति ॥१८॥.

Verse 19, p. 154 — the stanza of the hymn (see §1.2): the moon and the sun as prana and apana, the witness being Purusha.

Verse 20, p. 154 — the transition to the eightfold yoga:

समनस्कमिदं योगी सेवमान उपासनम् ।
अष्टाङ्गयोगयुक्तस्तन्मनस्कं स गच्छति ॥२०॥

English translation (1978 edition, p. 168): "20. Practising samanaska-yoga — this worship with the manas — the yogin, perfected in eight-limbed yoga, goes to Amanaska (Ishvara), to That which has no manas". There follows the enumeration of the eight limbs themselves: yama, niyama, asana, pranayama, pratyahara, dharana, dhyana, samadhi.

Verses 21–22, p. 155 — yama:

मनःप्रसादस्सन्तोषो मौनमिन्द्रियनिग्रहः ।
दया दाक्षिण्यमास्तिक्यमार्जवं मार्दवं क्षमा ॥२१॥
भावशुद्धिरहिंसा च ब्रह्मचर्यं स्मृतिर्धृतिः ।
इत्येवमादयोऽन्ये च मनस्साध्या यमाः स्मृताः ॥२२॥

Verse 23, p. 155 — niyama:

स्नानं शौचं क्रतुस्सत्यं जपो होमश्च तर्पणम् ।
तपो दानं तितिक्षा च नमस्कारः प्रदक्षिणम् ॥२३
व्रतोपवासाद्याश्चान्ये कायिकाः नियमाः स्मृताः ।

Verses 24–26, p. 156 — asanas. Fully analysed in §6.

Verse 27, p. 157 — pranayama:

रेचकः पूरकश्चैव कुम्भकः प्राणसंयमः ॥२७॥

"Restraint of the breath [consists of] exhalation (rechaka), inhalation (puraka) and retention (kumbhaka)".

Verses 28–30, p. 157 — pratyahara, dharana, dhyana, samadhi:

इन्द्रियाणां समस्तानां विषयेभ्यो निवारणम् ।

प्रत्याहार इति प्रोक्तं प्रत्याहारार्थवेदिभिः ॥२८॥
आधारे क्वापि मनसस्स्थापनं धारणोच्यते ।
ब्रह्मविष्णुशिवादीनां चिन्ता ध्यानं प्रचक्षते ॥२९॥
ध्यानादस्पन्दनं बुद्धेः समाधिरभिधीयते ।
अमनस्कसमाधिस्तु सर्वचिन्ताविवर्जितम् ॥३०॥

Verses 34–37, pp. 159–160 — the four signs of yoga (yoga-lakshanas), by stages:

मलमूत्रकफाल्पत्वमारोग्यं लघुता तनोः ।
सुगन्धस्स्वरवर्णत्वं प्रथमं योगलक्षणम् ॥३४
कण्टकाग्रेष्वसङ्गत्वं जलपङ्केष्वमज्जनम् ।
क्षुत्पिपासादिसहिष्णुत्वं द्वितीयं योगलक्षणम् ॥३५॥
बह्वन्नपानभोक्तृत्वमातपाग्निसहिष्णुता ।
दूरान्न श्रवणं दूरात्तृतीयं योगलक्षणम् ॥३६॥
मण्डूकह्लवनं भूमौ मर्कटह्लवनं द्रुमे ।
आकाशगमनं चेति चतुर्थं योगलक्षणम् ॥३७॥

The signs are: (1) a decrease of impurities, health, lightness of body, a pleasant smell, a clear voice; (2) insensitivity to the tip of a thorn, not sinking in water and mud, endurance of hunger and thirst; (3) the ability to eat and drink much, to endure heat and fire, to hear at a great distance; (4) the "leap of a frog" on the ground, the "leap of a monkey" in a tree, movement through the air. This is the same set as in the later hatha texts — but here it belongs to the eight-limbed yoga of a Vedantic commentary.

3.3. What the Treatise Does Not Contain

So as not to attribute to the text more than it contains:

- **There are no techniques of asanas.** Only names are listed. According to the 1895 edition, the description is placed outside the text: स्वस्तिकाद्यासनानां लक्षणानि योगग्रन्थेभ्योवगन्तव्यानि — "the characteristics of the asanas beginning with svastika are to be learned from yoga-texts" (p. 157).
- **There is no kundalini, no bandhas and no mudras in the section on asanas** — in none of the ullasas containing yogic material.
- **There is no Russian translation** — neither complete nor of the asana passage.
- **There is no critical apparatus to the varttika apart from the 1895 edition.** In the 2008 edition the whole volume contains two marks पाठान्तरम् ("variant reading"), and both are outside the section on asanas.

And three further things that should be stated plainly, so that the reader does not look for them in vain:

- **This is not a manual of yoga.** There are no descriptions of technique, no rules of performance, no contraindications; the enumeration of asanas occupies three verses and serves as a support for the argument about the Atman, not as a practical guide.
- **This is not hatha yoga.** The word "hatha" does not occur in the text; the complex of asanas, bandhas and mudras usually associated with hatha is absent here. The resemblance to later hatha texts lies only in the names of individual postures.
- **The numbering of the ullasas in the manuscripts does not match the printed one.** The ullasa that is the ninth in the editions is the seventh in the Ramtek manuscript and the sixth in the Jammu manuscript (§4.4, §4.5). A reference such as "ullasa IX" is a

reference **to the printed editions**.

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4. Manuscripts

4.1. The Seven Copies Used in the 1895 Edition

This is the only corpus described **by the editor himself**. The preface lists all seven copies:

> "The works comprised in this volume have been edited from the following manuscripts:— **I. The Text with Svayamprakāśa's commentary.** — A Telugu MS. belonging to Pandit Dakshinamurti Śāstri of the Oriental Library. — A Nāgarī MS. procured by Pandit Narahari Jośyar of the Oriental Library.
>
> — A Telugu MS. kindly lent by Pandit Gangādhara Śāstri of H. H. the Maharaja's Sanskrit College. **2. The Vārtika with Rāmatīrtha's commentary.** — A Grantha MS. of the Vārtika belonging to Sir K. Śeṣādri Iyer, Dewan of Mysore. **This codex is very much injured, and in consequence portions of the work have also disappeared.** — A Telugu MS. copy of the Vārtika kindly lent by Pandit Kāma Śāstriar of Madras. — A Grantha MS. of the Vārtika with Rāmatīrtha's commentary thereon, belonging to the Oriental Library."
>
> — Preface to the 1895 edition

On the quality of the copies:

> "The MSS. of Svayamprakāśa's commentary are indifferent; and all of them exhibit errors of commission and of omission, not purely clerical. **The copies of the Vārtika, on the other hand, are good, the last being by far the best.** Free as this last is from errors except a few clerical ones … it has been found a very valuable guide as furnishing a commentary which has enabled us to restore the text of the Vārtika to the form in which it was at the time of the commentator. The readings of the other two, where suggestive, have been given as foot-notes."
>
> — ibid.

And a "Postscript" — the seventh manuscript, obtained already at the final proof stage:

> "Just as I was going to send to the press the final proof of the pages of the Preface …, I came by **a recently written Telugu MS. of the Mánasollása with Rāna-tīrtha's commentary, belonging to Pandit Sītārāmaśāstri of the Bangalore Sanskrit College**. Though, as regards general accuracy, this MS. can hardly compare with the **Grantha MS. on which the present edition is mainly based**, its readings are in a few cases found decidedly superior to those of the other MS. or MSS. I note at the end of the volume not only all these readings and such variae lectiones as are otherwise deserving of notice, but also some typographical errors…"
>
> — ibid.; postscript dated 15 April 1895

What follows from this. The critical edition of 1895 is an assemblage of seven copies, and the principal copy was defective, part of the text having been lost in it. All the variants that the editor considered worthy of attention he placed **at the end of the volume** — and that is the only published corpus of variants of this text.

The editor gives no dates for the manuscripts: only script, material and owner. There are neither colophons nor palaeographic estimates in the preface.

4.2. Manuscripts Available in Digital Collections

Collection	Shelf mark	Metadata	Link
Kavikulguru Kalidas Sanskrit Universit Ramtek (Maharas Jnanayog Dr Shrikant Jichkar Knowled Resource Centre	**M-1192**, "Manasoll of Sureshva	18 leaves, 600 dpi, digitised under the state Namami programme, licence CC0, file 68.7 MB; Devanagari; **colophon read: no date, see §4.4**	`archive.org/details/NeGr_m-1192-manasollas-of-sureshvaracharya-kavikulguru-kalidas-sanskrit-university-ramtek-collection`
Dharmartha Trust at the Raghuna temple, Jammu (Gangotr collectio	**Almari 27, shelf 1, no. 6029**	125 leaves, 600 dpi, licence CC0, file 63.2 MB; Devanagari; **the colophon contains a Shaka-era year, the number not read, see §4.5**	`archive.org/details/ManasollasaAlm27Shlf16029DevanagariTantra`
Government Oriental Manuscr Library, Chennai (formerly Madras)	number not establishe	the catalogues are digitised (Descriptive Catalogue, vols 1–13, 1901–1911 and later), but the relevant entry has not been found in the volumes checked; according to Aufrecht the text is catalogued under "Dakshinamu	—

An important warning about both available manuscripts. The text file supplied by the Internet Archive for them is unusable: recognition was run with Devanagari selected, but in fact recognised Latin characters (the file metadata states the alphabet detected as Latin), and the result is garbage. The text can be read only from the images. A textual study of these

two manuscripts is a separate piece of work requiring an examination of all 18 leaves and of the colophon.

4.3. The Dating of the Manuscripts: What the Examination Yields

Witness	Dating	Basis
The seven copies of the 1895 edition	**not published**	the editor gives neither dates nor colophons
The Telugu copy obtained in 1895	**19th century**	direct characterisation: "a recently written Telugu MS."
Ramtek M-1192	**undated**	colophon read (§4.4): there is no year in it
Jammu, Almari 27 no. 6029	**a Shaka-era year is given, the number not read**	colophon partly read (§4.5)

The conclusion that can be asserted: no verified source offers a **fully dated** manuscript of the "Manasollasa". All the datings of the text itself given in §2 are derived from the dating of the author, not from the manuscripts. But this is no longer a blank space: one manuscript has been examined and proved undated, and in the second there is a date, and it only needs to be read to the end.

What remains to be done: to read the year number in the Jammu manuscript (§4.5); to consult the New Catalogus Catalogorum (University of Madras) under the letter "m"; to examine the manuscript catalogues of the Government Oriental Manuscripts Library (Chennai), the Sampurnanand Library (Varanasi), the Saraswati Mahal Library (Thanjavur), and Adyar.

4.4. Manuscript M-1192 (Ramtek): the Colophon Read

Leaf 18, the last two lines:

```
... इति श्रीदक्षिणामूर्तिस्तोत्रवार्तिके प्रपञ्चोपशमे सप्तमोल्लासः समाप्तः ॥२५॥
॥ इति श्रीमच्छङ्कराचार्यविरचितमानसोल्लासप्रकरणं ॥१८॥
```

"Thus in the 'Varttika' on the 'Dakshinamurti-stotra', [called] 'The Pacification of the Manifested', the seventh ullasa is completed. Thus [ends] the work 'Manasollasa', composed by Shri Shankaracharya."

Three conclusions:

- **there is no year** — neither era nor number; the "18" at the end is the leaf number;
- **the author of the varttika is not named**: the colophon names Shankara, that is, the work is ascribed to the author of the hymn, not to the author of the varttika;
- **the count of ullasas is different**: here the same ullasa is called the **seventh**, whereas in the printed editions it is the ninth.

On the first leaf there is a handwritten library card, filled in in English:

```
Accession No. 7202  M 1192
Title – मानसोल्लास
Author – ?
Date – ?
```

That is, **the library itself left the fields "author" and "date" empty**. The stamp "Checked

2012" is the year of the stock check, not a date.

What the manuscript yielded in addition. First, it is not only a varttika: the incipit begins श्रीगणेशाय नमः ॥ मङ्गलं दिशतु मे विनायको..., that is, both the hymn and the varttika are copied. Second, in verse 24 stands पद्मं — the same reading as in both printed editions, and not पश्यं, which is what machine recognition of the 1895 scan produced. This is an independent confirmation of the correct reading.

Crops: `sources/scans/mss/ramtek-m1192-kolofon.png`, `ramtek-m1192-bibliotechnaya-zapis.png`, `ramtek-m1192-stihi24-26.png`.

4.5. The Jammu Manuscript: a Date, but the Number Not Read

Leaf 120. In the last lines the formula ... शके ... can be read — a **Shaka-era year** is given. Before it come metrical particulars about the number of granthas, after it a wish for well-being.

The year number has not been read. The type has faded, the ink is uneven, at magnification the digits lose their shape, and different passes give different readings. The number is therefore not given here: a guess must not look like a fact. Two crops at natural resolution are supplied for the reading: `sources/scans/mss/jammu-6029-kolofon-celekom.png` and `jammu-6029-kolofon-dve-stroki.png`.

The conversion, once the number is read: the Shaka era begins in 78 CE, so Shaka year + 78 = CE (for example, 1400 Shaka is 1478 CE). A dated manuscript would give an upper bound for the text: the varttika could not have been composed later.

On the count of ullasas. In the Jammu manuscript the same ullasa is called the **sixth**, in the Ramtek one the seventh, in the printed editions the ninth. Three different counts for one text: one cannot refer to the manuscripts by ullasa numbers without collating them.

4.6. Where Else Copies Exist: Aufrecht's Catalogue

The seven copies of the 1895 edition are not the whole corpus. **Theodor Aufrecht's** "Catalogus Catalogorum" (1891–1903), in the article "Dakṣiṇāmūrtistotra", lists copies of the work "Manasollasa or Dakshinamurti-stotravarttika by Sureshvara" under library shelf marks:

> "C. Mānasollāsa or Dakṣiṇāmūrtistotravārttika by Sureśvara" IO. 443. W. p. 179. Hall p. 110. L. 1763. 1783. B. 4, 82. Ben. 67. Tüb. 16. Pheh 12. Rādh 6. NW. 280. Oudh VIII, 24. Burnell 91b. Bhr. 258. 259. Taylor 1, 1. Oppert 3454. II, 10042.

In the same place, in a separate nest, copies of Ramatirtha's commentary:

> "Mānasollāsavṛttāntavilāsa by Rāmatīrtha" IO. 443. W. p. 179. Hall p. 110. L. 141. 1763. 1783. K. 126. Oudh X, 22.

And in a third nest, copies of the hymn itself with this commentary:

> "C. Mānasollāsa or Dakṣiṇāmūrtistotravārttika by Sureśvara" BL. 184. Fl. 228. IO. 443. 968. 1998. Peters. 4, 21 (and C.). Stein 120.

What these abbreviations mean — and what I do not know. The marks `IO`, `L.`, `B.`, `Hall`, `Burnell`, `Oppert`, `Stein` and others refer to printed catalogues of individual collections, and

are deciphered by a key printed in the preface to the first volume of the "Catalogus Catalogorum". **I have not opened that key**, and therefore do not supply cities and collections here: such a decipherment must not be done from memory, since it is easy to confuse which catalogue is hidden behind a single letter. Only `IO` is securely identified — India Office Library, now the Oriental Manuscripts collection of the British Library in London — together with `BL`, the British Library itself.

What this list does not give. Aufrecht's catalogue is a summary of printed catalogues of the 19th and early 20th centuries. It does **not** confirm that a copy has survived: over a century manuscripts are lost, collections move, shelf marks change. And as a rule it says nothing about dating.

4.7. What Is Available and What Is Not

State	What	How many
Digitised and downloadable without registration	Ramtek M-1192; Jammu, Almari 27 no. 6029	**2 manuscripts**
Partly digitised	The catalogues of the Government Oriental Manuscripts Library (Chennai), volumes of 1895–1911 — but the relevant entry has not been found in the volumes checked	—
Not digitised	Copies under Aufrecht's shelf marks: the British Library and the India Office Library (London) and a number of further collections listed in §4.6	**of the order of two dozen marks**
Not verified	The National Mission for Manuscripts database of India, NAMAMI ("Pandulipi Patala", pandulipipatala.nic.in)	—

About NAMAMI one must speak plainly: it is there that all the manuscripts of India are registered, and it is precisely this database that could give an exact answer — how many copies of the "Manasollasa" exist and where they are held. **It could not be checked**: the domain resolves to an address, but the connection is not established. Hence a dash stands in the table, not a number. That is more honest than an estimate.

The practical conclusion. For textual work only two manuscripts are at present really available, and both are in Devanagari and both lack a date (in the Jammu one a year is given but not read, see §4.5). All the remaining copies, including the damaged Grantha manuscript on which the 1895 edition is built, are available only in reading rooms. Until they are collated, it is premature to assert anything about the manuscript tradition of the text.

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5. Printed Editions

Year	What	Imprint
1895	Sanskrit: varttika + stotra + Svayamprakasha's "Tattvasudha" + Ramatirtha's commentary. Ed. **A. Mahadeva Sastri** and **K. Rangacharya**	Government Oriental Library Series, **Bibliotheca Sanskrita No. 6**, Mysore

1899	English translation with commentaries; the texts of the stotra and of the "Dakshinamurti-upanishad"	Madras; "First Published 1899" (as stated in the 3rd edition)
1920	2nd edition	"In this edition the Sanskrit texts of Manasollasa and Pranava-vartika have been added, while in the first edition the texts of Dakshinamurti-stotra and Dakshinamurti-Upanishad [only]" — Preface to the Second Edition
1978	3rd edition, revised and enlarged	Samata Books, Madras; lxxv + 223 pp.; OCLC 8168609 (per the University of Wisconsin–Madison catalogue)
1905	**Tamil** translation with commentary	Melmangalam T. Sundararaja Sarma; Sri Jnanananda Niketan, Tapovanam (Villupuram)
1972	**Kannada**: transliteration and translation by Swami Sachchidanandra	Adhyatma Prakasha, Holenarasipura
1987	Sanskrit + the commentary **"Madhuri"** of Swami Maheshananda Giri	Shri Dakshinamurti Math, Varanasi (the scan description gives Agra, Nirmal Chitran Press, 1987)
1988 / 1990	**D. S. Subbaramaiya**, Sri Dakṣiṇāmūrtistotram: A Study Based on the Mānasollāsa and the Tattvasudhā, 2 vols	Dakshinamnaya Sri Sharada Peetham, Sringeri
2008	Sanskrit + the commentary **"Manasollasa-vardhini"** of Anantakrishna Shastri (d. 15 November 1964), ed. **Dr Sachchidananda Mishra**; preface by Swami Maheshananda Giri	Shri Dakshinamurti Math Prakashan, Varanasi. Imprint: «प्रथमसंस्करण, विक्रमाब्द २०६५, भगवत्पादाब्द १२२०, ईस्वी सन् २००८»
(reprints)	"Dakshinamurti Stotra ... with Manasollasa and Pranava Vartika"	Samata Books (1978, 3rd ed.); see also Indian reprints of the 1899/1920 editions

A note on the 2008 imprint: «भगवत्पादाब्द १२२०» is a year in the "era of Shankara" (year 1220), not a historical date. Vikrama 2065 = 2008 CE.

The commentaries are in effect different readings of the text:

Commentary	Author	Date	What it gives
"Tattvasudha"	Svayamprakasha Yati	16th c. (more precisely not established)	A commentary **on the hymn**, not on the varttika; printed together with it
Ramatirtha	Ramatirtha	17th c. (according to Harshananda)	A commentary **on the varttika**; included in the 1895 edition and determining the understanding of the text in the southern tradition
"Madhuri"	Swami Maheshananda Giri	20th c.	Padachcheda (word analysis) and a Hindi translation

"Manasollasa-vardhini"	Anantakrishna Shastri	20th c.	Commissioned specifically to answer the hypothesis of Abhinavagupta's authorship

6. Asanas: What the Text Says and Which Edition to Quote

6.1. Which Edition to Quote — the Answer

The principal edition for quotation is that of 1895 (Mysore, Bibliotheca Sanskrita No. 6), printed page 156. The reasons:

1. It is the **first critical** edition and the **only** one in which the varttika is provided with an apparatus of variants.
2. It is freely available in at least two independent scans.
3. The numbering of ullasas and verses coincides with that of the 2008 edition, so the reference `IX.24` works for both.

The reading was verified against the page image: `sources/scans/mss/1895-str156-stihi24-26.png`.

6.2. The Text of the Section

Below is the text according to the 1895 edition, p. 156. It **agrees word for word** with the text of the 2008 edition in all six lines; the only difference is the placement of the danda before the number of verse 24 (see §0). That is, there are no divergences between the two editions in this section — which is confirmed by §6.5.

स्वस्तिकं गोमुखं पद्मं हंसाख्यं ब्राह्ममासनम् ॥२४
नृसिंहं गरुडं कूर्मं नागाख्यं वैष्णवासनम् ।
वीरं मयूरं वज्राख्यं सिद्धाख्यं रौद्रमासनम् ॥२५॥
योन्यासनं विदुश्शाक्तं शैवं पश्चिमतानकम् ।
निरालम्बनयोगस्य निरालम्बनमासनम् ॥२६॥
निरालम्बतया ध्यानं निरालम्बस्सदाशिवः ।

Translation: "Svastika, gomukha, padma, hamsa — the brahma-asana. Nrisimha, garuda, kurma, naga — the vaishnava-asana. Vira, mayura, vajra, siddha — the raudra-asana. The yoni posture, as they know, is the shakta one; the shaiva one is pashchima-tanaka. For niralambana-yoga there is the niralambana-asana; contemplation is without support, and the supportless [Atman] is Sadashiva."

English translation (1978 edition, p. 170):

> "24-26. Svastika, Gomukha, Padma, Hamsa — these are the Brahmic postures (Asanas). Nrisimha, Garuda, Kurma, Naga — these are the Vaishnava postures. Vira, Mayura, Vajra, Siddha — these are the Raudra postures. Yoni is the Sakta posture. Paschima-tanaka is the Saiva posture." "The posture for the Niralambana-Yoga is niralambana (lit. propless, involving no specific position of hands, feet or other members of the body); meditation should be on the Niralambana, and the Niralambana is Sadasiva, the Unconditioned, the Paramatman."

6.3. The Commentary on Verse 24 — the Classification by Deity

Immediately after the verses, on the same page 156:

आसनान्याह — स्वस्तिकमित्यादिना ॥ स्वस्तिकाद्यासनचतुष्टयं ब्राह्मं ब्रह्मदेवत्यमित्यर्थः ।
नृसिंहादिचतुष्टयं वैष्णवं विष्णुदेवत्यम् । वीरादिचतुष्टयं रौद्रं रुद्रदेवत्यम् ।
योन्यासनं शक्तिदेवत्यं विदुरित्यर्थः । पश्चिमतानकं नामासनं शैवं विदुर्योगिन इति योजना ॥

"He speaks of the asanas: 'svastika' and the rest. The group of four asanas beginning with svastika is the brahma one, that is, having Brahma as its deity. The group of four beginning with nrisimha is the vaishnava one, with Vishnu as its deity. The group of four beginning with vira is the raudra one, with Rudra as its deity. The yoni posture, as is to be understood, has Shakti as its deity. And the posture called pashchima-tanaka the yogins consider to be the shaiva one."

This is precisely the **classification of asanas by deity** — the one of which the editor wrote that its source is the Shaiva agamas (see §1.2). In the text it is carried through completely: 4 + 4 + 4 + 1 + 1 asanas for five deities, plus a sixth category — the "supportless" one, which is not an asana in the proper sense.

6.4. Where to Look for Descriptions of the Asanas — and the Divergence between the Editions

For verse 24 the two editions give **different** instructions.

1895 edition, p. 157 (`sources/scans/mss/1895-str157-yogagranthebhyah.png`):

स्वस्तिकाद्यासनानां लक्षणानि योगग्रन्थेभ्योवगन्तव्यानि ॥

"The characteristics of the asanas beginning with svastika are to be learned from yoga-texts."

2008 edition, p. 119 (`sources/scans/mss/2008-str119-gurupadesha-yogopanishatsu.png`):

अथासनानि विभजते — स्वस्तिकमिति ।
इम आसनप्रकाराः गुरूपदेशगम्याः पद्मवज्रासनादयः केचन योगोपनिषत्सु निर्दिष्टाः ।

"Then he divides the asanas: 'svastika' and the rest. These kinds of asanas are to be reached through the instruction of a guru; some, beginning with padma- and vajrasana, are indicated in the yoga-upanishads."

How this is to be assessed — without forcing:

- both phrases are set within the section मानसोल्लासवार्तिकम्, that is, **both editors regarded them as the text of the varttika**;
- in the 2008 edition the main text is set in bold and the interpretation in roman type; the disputed phrase is set **in bold**, that is, it is not an insertion by the editor;
- the difference concerns two points: गुरूपदेशगम्याः ("to be reached through the instruction of a guru") against योगग्रन्थेभ्योवगन्तव्याः ("to be learned from yoga-texts"), and the presence of पद्मवज्रासनादयः ... योगोपनिषत्सु निर्दिष्टाः ("beginning with padma- and vajrasana … indicated in the yoga-upanishads"), which is entirely absent from the 1895 edition.

The cause of the divergence has not been established. The possible explanations — all three as yet unverified — are: (a) different readings of different manuscripts (recall that the principal Grantha manuscript was defective and part of the text lost in it); (b) in 2008 the

text of a later commentary has been mixed into the varttika; (c) in 1895 the phrase is abridged, and in 2008 given in full. The question can be settled only by collation with the Ramtek M-1192 and Jammu no. 6029 manuscripts.

Why this matters. The statement "the Manasollasa refers to the yoga-upanishads" rests on the 2008 edition, not on the 1895 edition. Until the manuscripts are collated, the correct formulation is:

> "In the 2008 edition (Varanasi) this verse is commented upon with a reference to the yoga-upanishads; in the 1895 edition (Mysore) the reference at this point is to yoga-texts."

6.5. Collation of the Verses Themselves: 1895 against 2008

Checked against the scans of both books. **There are no divergences of substance.** The only difference that could be found:

- 1895: निरालम्बस्सदाशिवः
- 2008: निरालम्बः सदाशिवः

This is a variant of sandhi (the rules of word junction in writing); the meaning is the same.

For completeness: in the 1987 edition ("Madhuri") the same stanza, in the word analysis (padachcheda), is set as विदुः शाक्तम् (separately), and the preceding half of the stanza is marked ॥२४ क॥. This means that the stanza boundaries there are shifted by half a verse: the verse number will coincide, but the boundaries will not.

6.6. Separately: पश्चिमतानक — Not "Pashchimottanasana"

पश्चिमतानक (pashchima-tanaka, literally "that which stretches the back [of the body]") is classified in the text as a **shaiva** posture. In the later hatha tradition the name has not survived in this form, and the modern "pashchimottanasana" is a different formation (पश्चिमोत्तान). They must not be identified. This is a case where "similar" does not mean "the same".

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7. What Remains Unestablished

The list of honest gaps is at the same time a programme of work:

1. **The dating of the manuscripts.** No verified source offers a dated manuscript of the "Manasollasa". The colophons of Ramtek M-1192 and Jammu no. 6029 are needed, together with a search in the New Catalogus Catalogorum.
2. **The cause of the divergence in the commentary on verse 24** (yoga-texts against guru and yoga-upanishads).
3. **The literal argument of Thrasher 1979 and Nakamura 1983** — their texts are not available in the public domain; there is only the paraphrase in Dragonetti–Tola and in the Stanford Encyclopedia.
4. **The complete apparatus of variants of the 1895 edition** for verses 24–26 — the list is placed at the end of the volume and reads badly in the available text files; an examination of the last pages of the scan is required.
5. **The number of shlokas** (367) — a figure from a reference work; the available editions contain no continuous count.

6.

The precise date of Svayamprakasha's "Tattvasudha" — the 16th century is repeated in the literature, but no substantiation of it is to be found either in the prefaces to the editions of 1895, 1978 and 2008 or in the accessible catalogues. The statement is left without support in a source and requires verification against the colophons of the "Tattvasudha" manuscripts.

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8. How to Verify Everything Said Here Yourself

Instructions for anyone who wishes to check the quotations:

1. Open the page of the edition on the Internet Archive and download the `…_jp2.zip` file (the **SHOW ALL** button in the downloads section). These are the original scans.
2. To establish which leaf corresponds to which page, download `…_scandata.xml` and look for `pageNumber`. For example, in the scan of the 1895 edition leaf 166 = printed p. 155, leaf 167 = p. 156, leaf 168 = p. 157. In the scan of the 2008 edition leaf 170 = p. 119, leaf 171 = p. 120.
3. Extract the required leaf and look at it:

```
import zipfile
from PIL import Image
z = zipfile.ZipFile("downloaded_jp2.zip")
name = [n for n in z.namelist() if n.endswith("_0167.jp2")][0]
open("leaf.jp2", "wb").write(z.read(name))
im = Image.open("leaf.jp2")
im.resize((im.width // 3, im.height // 3)).save("view.png")
```

4. Ready-made crops of all quoted pages are already in `sources/scans/mss/`.

If other manuscripts need to be sought. The National Mission for Manuscripts database of India, NAMAMI (pandulipipatala.nic.in), is the register of all the manuscripts of the country; its filters include switches "Digitization = Yes" and "Public View = Yes", which select what has been digitised and is open. The database may be inaccessible from some countries — that is a restriction of access, not an absence of records. The printed union of copies by library is Aufrecht's catalogue, analysed in §4.6.

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9. Glossary

Term	Meaning
varttika (वार्त्तिक)	a genre of commentary: it explains what has been said, supplies what has not been said, and corrects what has been badly said (definition in §1.1)
ullasa (उल्लास)	"wave"; a unit of division of the text, one for each stanza of the hymn
stotra	a hymn, a text of praise
bhashya (भाष्य)	a commentary on a base text (more independent than a varttika)

Advaita Vedanta	non-dual Vedanta: the doctrine of the identity of the Atman and the Brahman
Atman / Brahman	the individual self / the absolute principle
avidya	ignorance, because of which the Atman is not recognised
mahavakya	a "great saying" of the Upanishads, for example "tat tvam asi"
shabda-aparoksha	immediate knowledge arising from a word (from a saying of the Upanishads)
sphota	the doctrine that the meaning of a word manifests in the sound as a whole
Bhamati / Vivarana	two sub-schools of Advaita, differing among other things in where avidya is located
padachcheda	the analysis of a continuous text into separate words
Devanagari, Grantha, Telugu	the scripts in which the manuscripts are written
colophon	the concluding note of the scribe at the end of a manuscript (often with a date)
critical edition	an edition reconstructed from several manuscripts, with the variants indicated
apparatus of variants	the list of variant readings given beside the text or at the end of a book
terminus ante quem	"the boundary before which": a date later than which the text cannot have been written
shaiva, vaishnava, raudra, shakta, brahma	relating respectively to Shiva, Vishnu, Rudra, Shakti, Brahma

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10. Sources

Editions of the text

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- 3rd English edition, Samata Books, Madras 1978: `archive.org/details/wg879`
- Tamil edition of 1905: `archive.org/details/DakshinamurhyStotramWithManasaulasam`
- Kannada edition of 1972: `archive.org/details/Sachidanandendra_Swamiji_Sureshwaracharya_-_Manasollasa`
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Manuscripts

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- S. Kuppuswami Sastri, introduction to the edition of the "Brahmasiddhi", 1937 (reprinted 1984)
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- P. S. Roodurmum, Bhāmatī and Vivaraṇa Schools of Advaita Vedānta, 2002, pp. 29–30
- Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy, article "Śaṅkara", section 1

Other

- The Original Śaṅkarācārya, easterntradition.org (traditional dates according to the guru-paramparas)
- Hindupedia, article "Mānasollāsa" (Swami Harshananda)
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Evidence crops (sources/scans/mss/): 1895-str156-celekom.png, 1895-str156-stihi24-26.png, 1895-str157-celekom.png, 1895-str157-yogagranthebhyah.png, 2008-str119-celekom.png, 2008-str119-gurupadesha-yogopanishatsu.png